



Lead Quality Analysis & Optimization Strategy

Data-driven insights to evaluate performance and capture the 20% CPL premium.

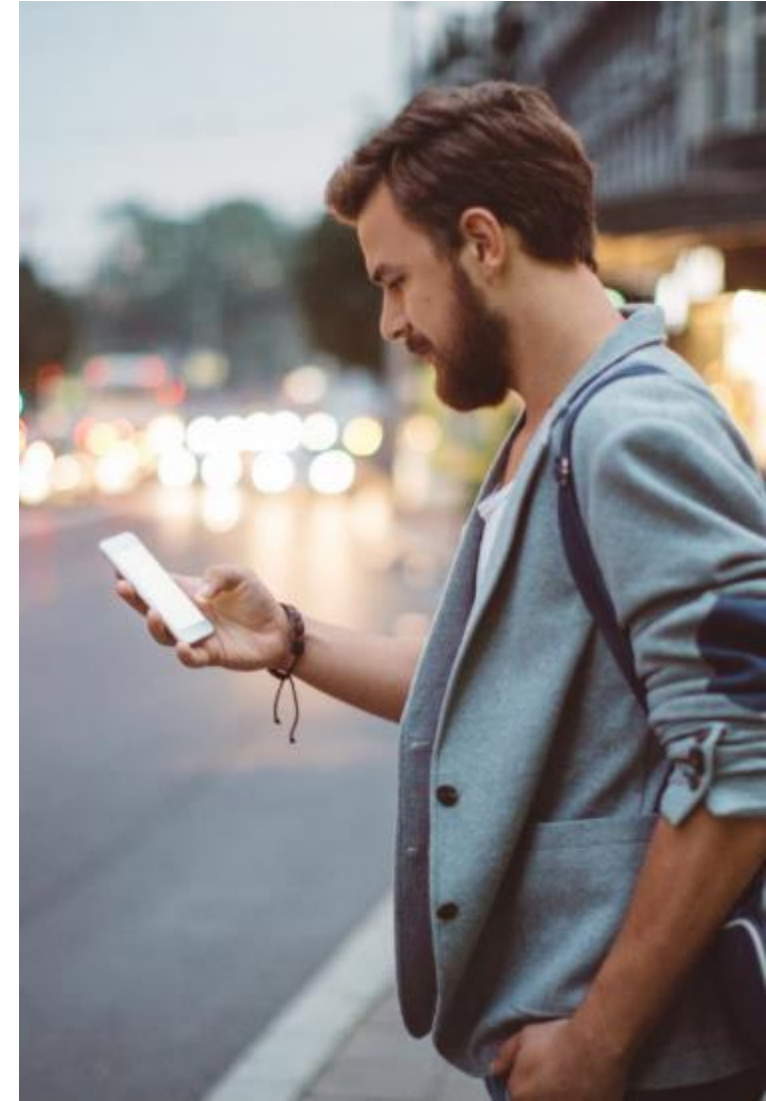
-By Vivek Upadhyay

Agenda

Lead Quality Trends: Overview of quality performance over time and statistical significance.

Key Drivers of Quality: Analysis of how ad creative, user persona, and traffic placement impact our success metrics

The 20% CPL Opportunity: Our strategic roadmap to increase aggregate lead quality from 8.0% to 9.6% to secure the \$33 CPL



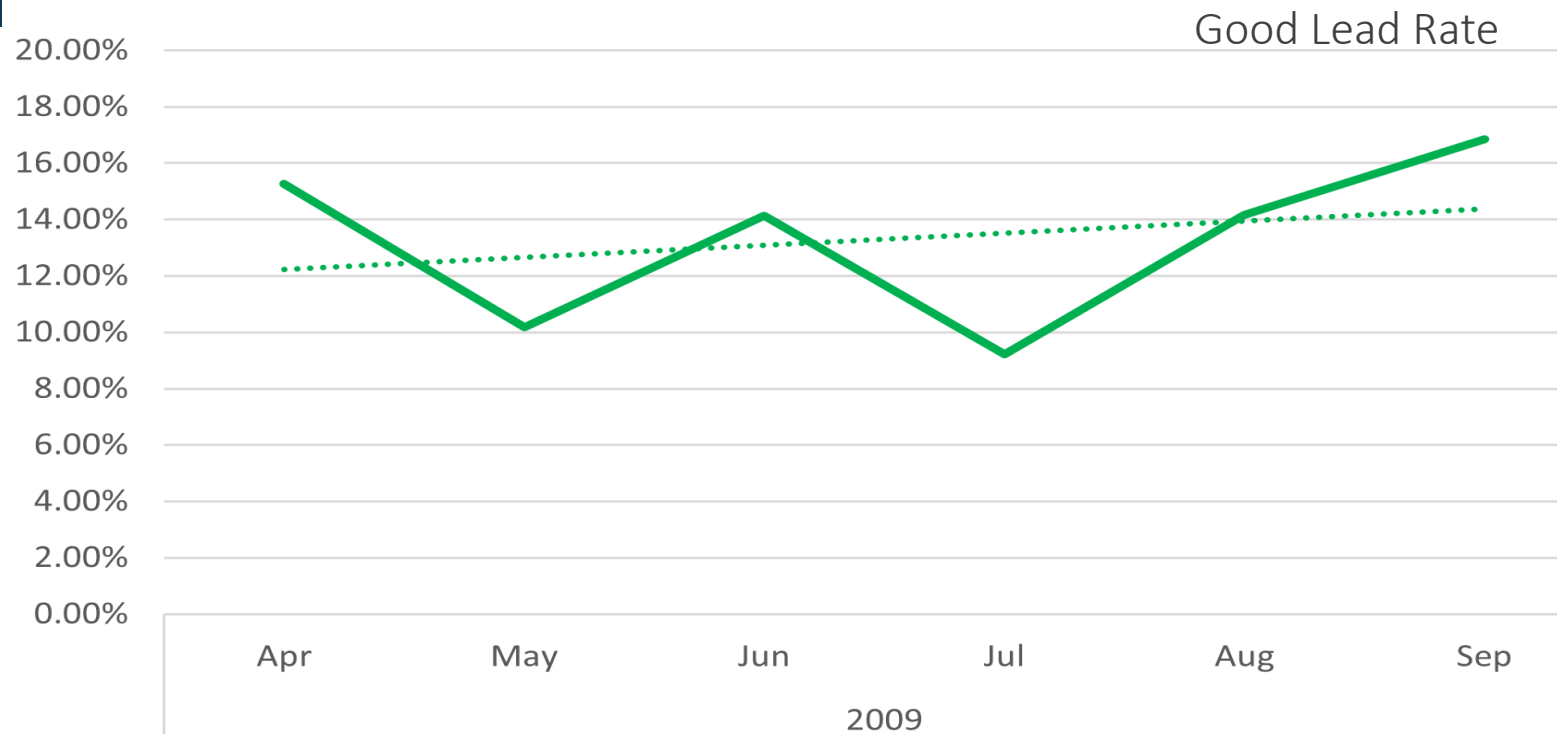
Lead Quality Trends Over Time

Statistical Significance

- **The Variance:** Lead quality does not follow a stable trendline. The "Good" lead rate experienced an extreme **83% relative swing**—plummeting from 15.3% in April to a floor of 9.2% in July, before spiking to a peak of 16.9% in September.
- **The Math Test:** for chi-sq test , $p = 9.15 \times 10^{-18}$ thus $p \sim 0$ leading to rejection of NULL hypothesis
- Suggesting wild swings in **GOOD** leads is not random but cause of underlying operational shift

High Volatility with Recent Upward Momentum

Over the analyzed 6-month period, aggregate lead quality fluctuates drastically rather than showing a stable, flat trend. The "Good" lead rate dropped to a concerning low of 9.2% in July but has since rebounded sharply to a peak of 16.8% in September.





Drivers of Quality – The Financial Persona

Debt Capacity is the Primary Qualifier; Address Match Drives Volume.

- **Address Verification:** While validation scores initially seemed critical, quality rates are uniform across segments (~13%). However, the "High Match" and "Missing Data" profiles are our core volume drivers, combining to account for 95% of all "Good" leads (372 out of 393).
- **Reported Debt (Quality Driver):** Lead qualification is highly sensitive to the applicant's reported debt burden. The lowest tier (\$7,500–\$10,000) represents a highly inefficient segment, converting at only 7.0% with a massive 24.6% disqualification ("Bad") rate.
- **The Sweet Spots:** Conversely, the middle-to-upper brackets (\$10k–\$15k and \$70k–\$90k) act as high-efficiency targets, yielding 18.5% and 19.0% "Good" rates, respectively.



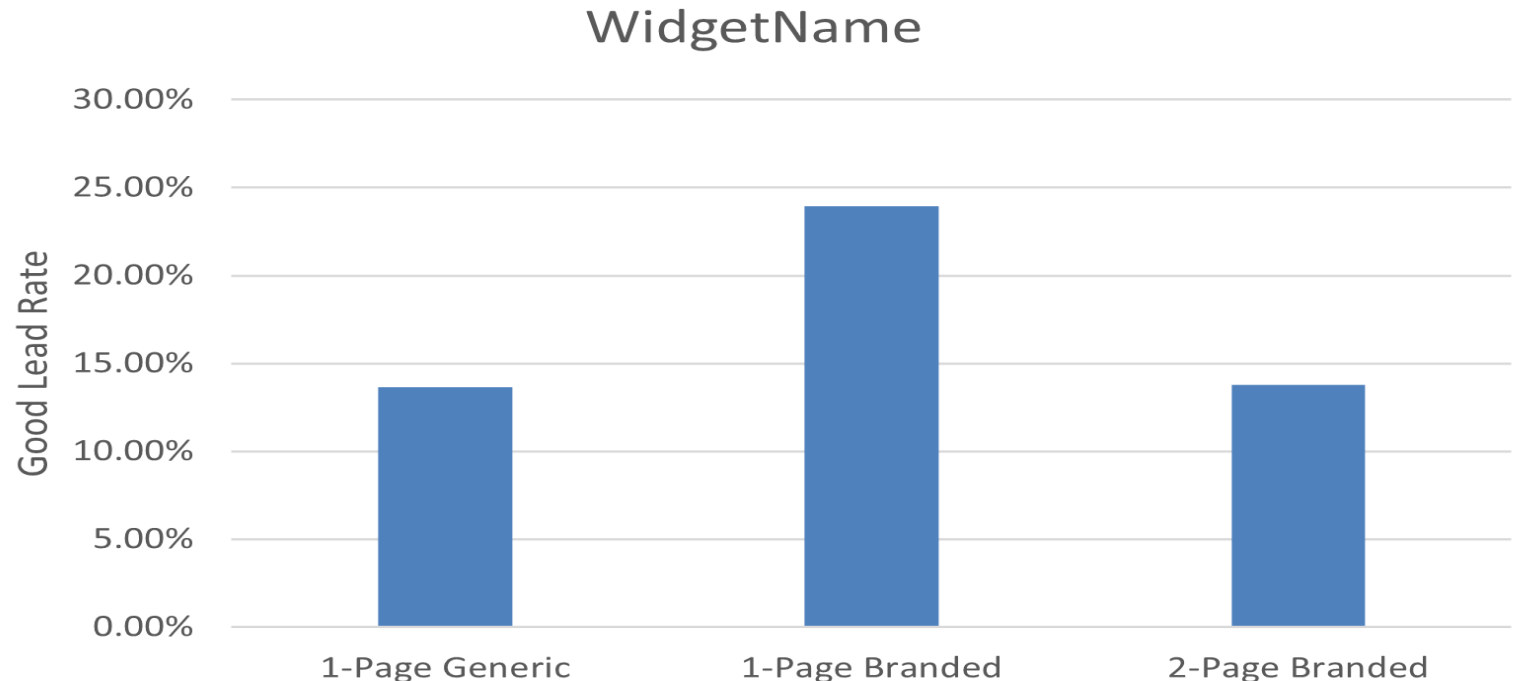
Drivers of Quality – Ad Creative & UX Friction

Analytical Conclusion

- The data definitively shows that once trust is established via branding, adding the extra friction of a second page reduces overall lead quality. The 1-page branded widget is our undisputed top performer.

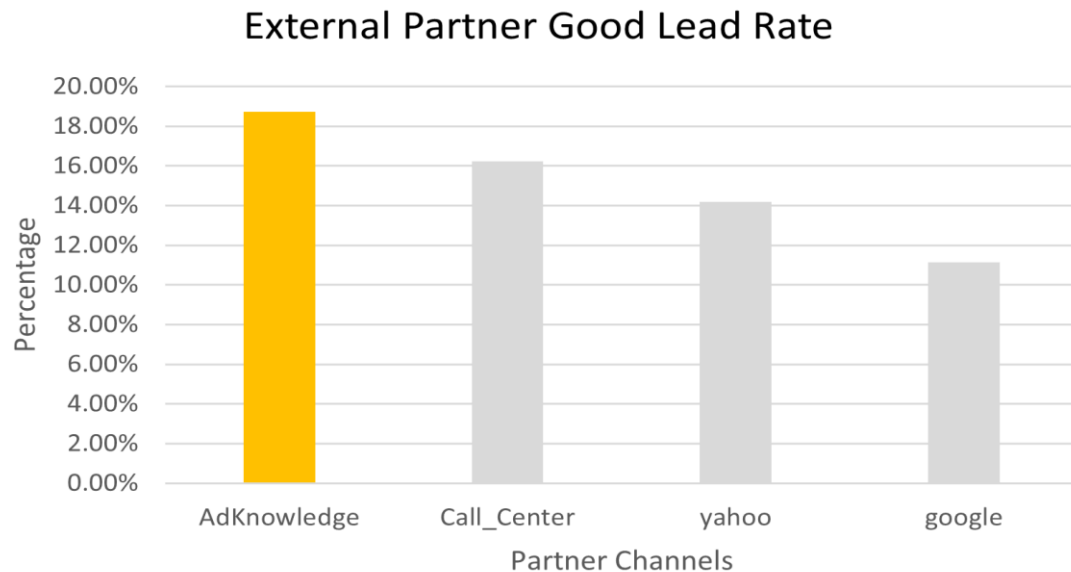
Brand Trust + Low Friction = Maximum Conversion

- The UX Friction Penalty:** Introducing a second page to the user journey severely damages intent. For the branded CreditSolutions campaigns, moving from a 1-page (1DC) to a 2-page (2DC) form cuts lead quality by more than half, dropping from 23.4% to just 10.7%.
- The Trust Premium:** When comparing 1-page forms, displaying the advertiser's logo (CreditSolutions) yields a 23.4% "Good" rate, vastly outperforming the generic, unbranded 1-page forms (16.1%)



Drivers of Quality-Placements & Channels

High-Intent Partners Outperform;
Call Center Creates Volume
Anomalies



External Partner Intent: External traffic sources show a wide variance in lead intent. 'AdKnowledge' is the strongest volume partner, converting 'Good' leads at 18.71%. Interestingly, 'Yahoo' (14.1%) outperforms 'Google' (11.1%).



Reallocating ad spend away from underperforming Google campaigns and heavily into AdKnowledge is a clear driver to immediately lift our aggregate quality rate.



The Call Center Anomaly: Call center-generated leads have a higher 'Good' rate (16.2%) compared to self-serve online forms (12.6%). However, the call center also produces a significantly higher 'Bad' rate (24.3% vs 15.3%)

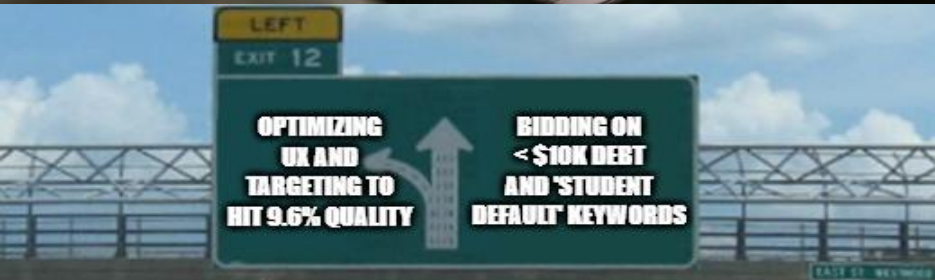


Data Correlation: The data for PublisherCampaignName perfectly mirrors the data for PublisherZoneName (Top Right = Call Center; Top Left = Online). This suggests our call center agents are likely using a specific internal portal/placement to manually enter these leads, and while they push through more qualified candidates, they also force through more unqualified ones.



Roadmap to the High CPL

- **The Opportunity:** The advertiser has offered to increase our Cost Per Lead (CPL) from \$30 to \$33 if we can lift our aggregate lead quality from 8.0% to 9.6%.
- **The Strategic Shift:** We do not need to acquire new, unproven traffic sources to hit this target. Our current baseline is artificially suppressed by a few highly inefficient segments. By cutting the "dead weight" and funneling our existing budget into our proven high-performers, we will mathematically exceed the 9.6% quality threshold and capture the premium.



Optimize UX (Scale the Winners)

Route traffic exclusively away from 2-page forms and generic designs

- Consolidating impressions into the 1-page branded forms (CreditSolutions) will leverage our highest-converting asset (23.3% Good rate)

Refine Targeting (Cut the Dead Weight)

Refocus targeting on the \$10k–\$15k and \$70k–\$90k sweet spots.

- Immediately stop bidding on the <\$10k debt bracket, which is yielding a massive 24.6% "Bad" rate.

Filter Intent (Reallocate Budgets)

Shift broad Google Search spend to our highest-intent external partner, AdKnowledge (18.7% Good rate).

- Within the remaining Google budget, immediately implement negative keywords for unqualified terms like "student" and "default".



Thanks for Reviewing

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